

Concise but significant* handbook to M5 statistics



What measurement level?

Variable
data

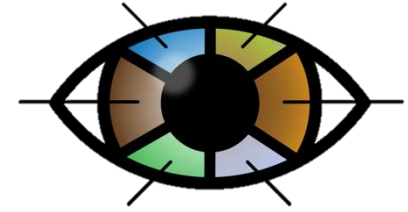
Categorical

ABC

*Labels, making groups,
distinct categories*

Nominal

Categories are equal (= and ≠)



Ordinal

There is an order to the categories (> and <)



Interval

Equal distance between the values (+ and -)



Continuous

123

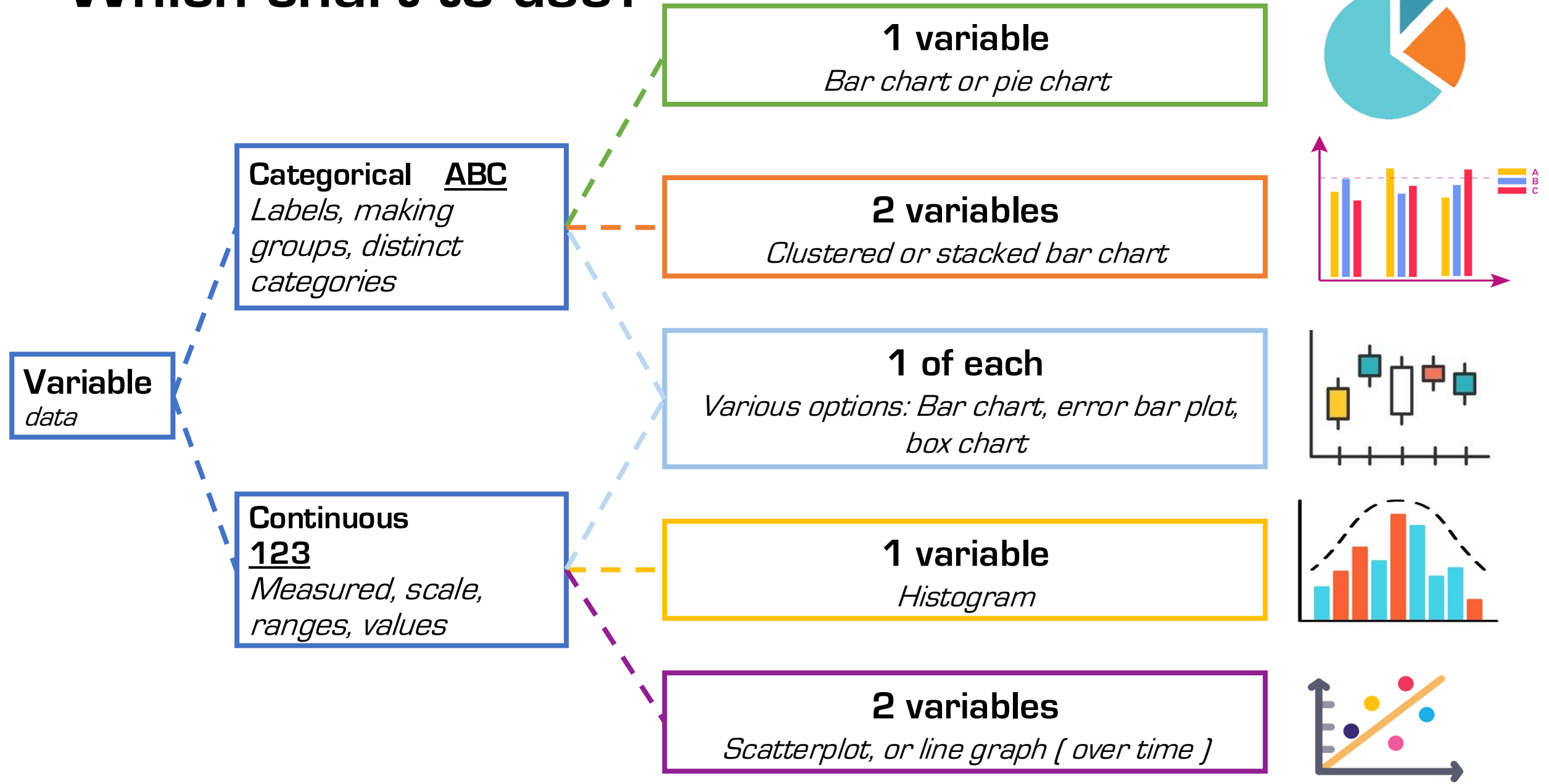
*Measured, scale,
ranges, values*

Ratio

*There is an absolute 0 point (* and /)*



Which chart to use?



Making hypotheses

A research hypothesis is a concise statement about the expected result of an experiment or project. Two types exist:

- the **null hypothesis** H_0 Assumed to be factual, normal, ‘what there is’ in the current world.
- the **alternative hypothesis** H_1 / H_a What could or might be, what we look for out of the ordinary.

→ Always formulate H_1 first, then add H_0 as the opposite.

Example: A researcher tests the effectiveness of a new medication. In an “alternative” world, the new medication would have some effect, and that is also what we hope and expect, so H_1 is: “the medication makes a difference”:

H_1 = the medication has an effect ALSO $\mu_{\text{test}} \neq \mu_{\text{control}}$

Normally, however, a random pill does not do a lot, so the “normal reality” of H_0 is: the medication has no effect. In that case, we do not expect any difference between the means (μ ’s) of the test group and the control group:

H_0 = the medication has no effect ALSO $\mu_{\text{test}} = \mu_{\text{control}}$

The hypotheses above do not have any direction. They simply deal with a possible difference in μ ’s. This test is **two-sided**: any result could be more or less, better or worse. However, we could also formulate a hypothesis with a direction, in which case we could say: the drug **improves** health. Now, we test **one-sided**: the result of the test group should be higher/better.

H_1 = the drug has a positive effect ALSO $\mu_{\text{test}} > \mu_{\text{control}}$

Hypotheses, $\bar{x}$, μ , p , and distribution

Statistical tests – simply put – calculate how likely it would be to find a result like the one in your sample (or an even more extreme result) if H_0 were true. This probability is the p -value.

Why? If H_1 says that there really is a difference or effect, we want the difference found in our sample to be large enough that it would be unlikely to occur just by chance if H_0 were true.

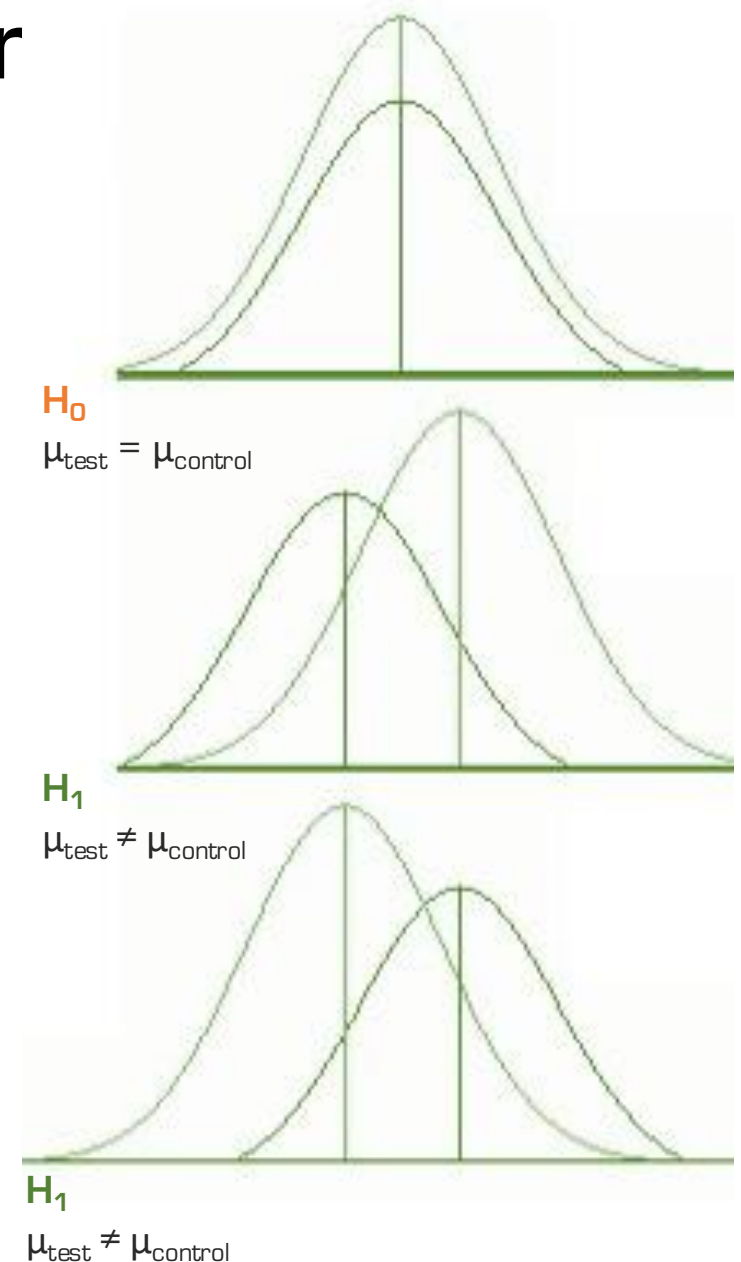
Normally, we use a critical p -value (α) of 0.05. If $p < 0.05$, our result would be sufficiently unlikely under H_0 , so we reject H_0 in favour of H_1 . If $p \geq 0.05$, we do not reject H_0 because there is not enough evidence for H_1 .

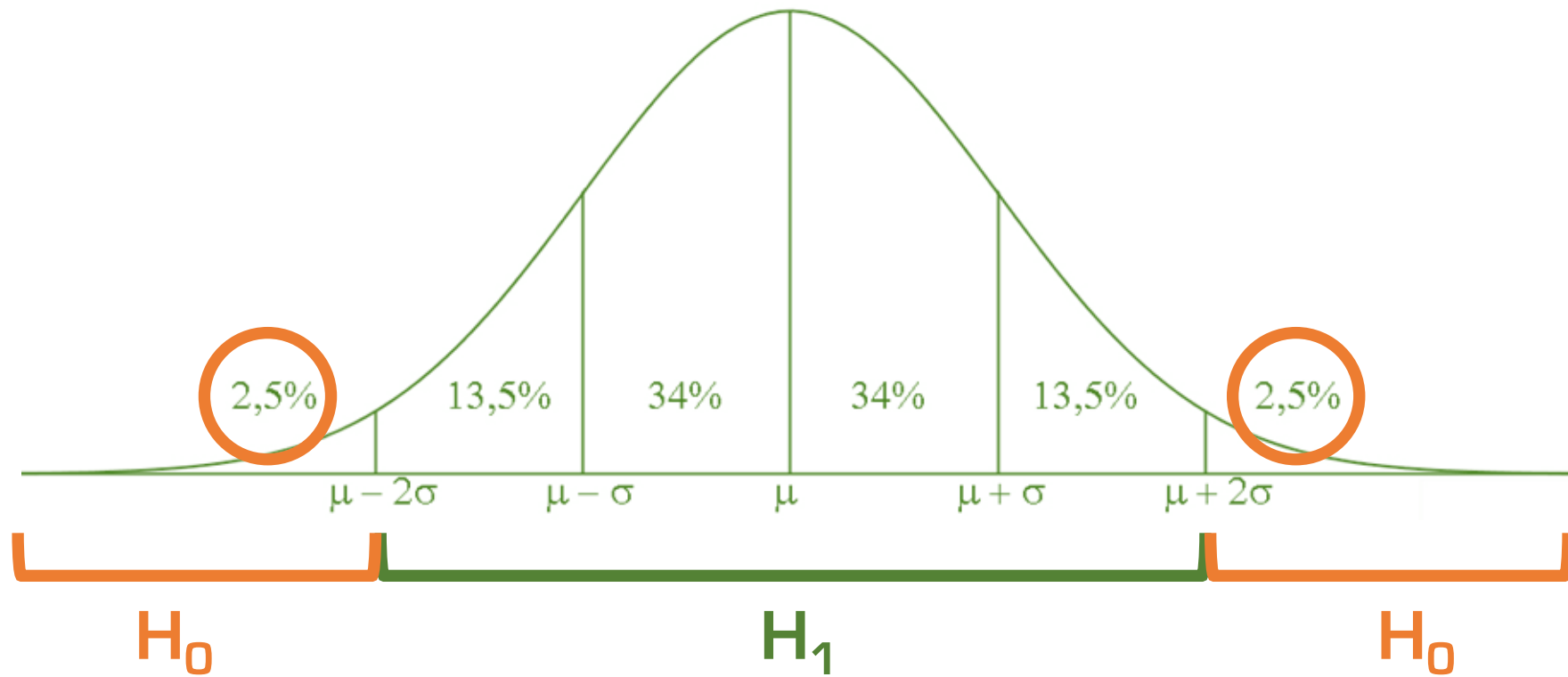
A 95% confidence interval gives us a range of plausible values for the population parameter we are estimating. In many common two-sided tests, if the value predicted by H_0 falls outside the 95% confidence interval, the result is significant at the 0.05 level.

NOTES:

- A. When testing hypotheses about means, we use μ (mu) for the population mean. When testing hypotheses about proportions (parts/shares), we use π (pi) for the population proportion. Hypotheses are therefore formulated using μ or π .
- B. μ is the true mean of the whole population, but because populations are often too large to measure completely, μ is usually unknown. We therefore take a sample and calculate $\bar{x}$ (x-bar), the mean of that sample, which we use to estimate μ .

If $p < \alpha$ we reject H_0 in favour of H_1 . If $p \geq \alpha$, we do not reject H_0 .





If the resulted probability p is below the chosen critical value p (e.g. 0.05), then
there are limited cases in the H_0 region and we can reject H_0
&

we assume there are enough cases in the H_1 region to assume a difference in μ 's and support H_1 , so we accept H_1 .



If you test one-sided, then the test's p-value has to be divided by 2 (you can't 'use' the other side of the distribution). In

Jamovi you can tick boxes for testing either two-sided or one-sided, in SPSS the results table reports both.

Types of error

If you use statistics to make decisions on hypotheses, the chance exists that you draw false conclusions. Options here are:

Type 1-error, or a false positive

The rejection of the H_0 when it is actually true and should be assumed
Thus also meaning: accepting H_1 while you shouldn't.

Type 2-error, or a false negative

Not rejecting H_0 while it is actually false and should be rejected
Thus also meaning: not accepting H_1 while you actually should.

Type 3-error, for the enthusiasts

Rejecting H_0 because the numbers say so, but based on wrong reasoning/methodology

E.g.1 Concluding 'the drug *improves* health' with two-tailed testing

E.g.2 The drug has a positive effect and people feel better, but it doesn't concern the theoretical effect and illness that was studied

Validity and Reliability

Validity refers to the accuracy of a measure: do you measure what is supposed to be measure?

e.g. A new questionnaire is used and the results align with those of previously used questionnaires on the same topic among a comparable population 👍

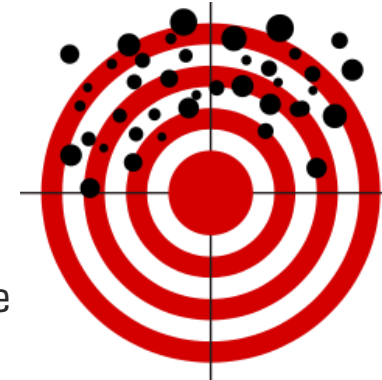
e.g. A thermometer is placed next to the door in a controlled laboratory fridge 🙄

Reliability refers to the consistency of a measure and data: can results be reproduced under the same conditions, and if the dataset size N increases, does the outcome of the test increasingly approaches the correct outcome?

e.g. A respondent answers 'yes' to *Do you eat meat?* and 'no' to *Are you a vegetarian?* 👍

e.g.2 The more respondents (higher N), the more significant differences are found, which strengthens the outcome

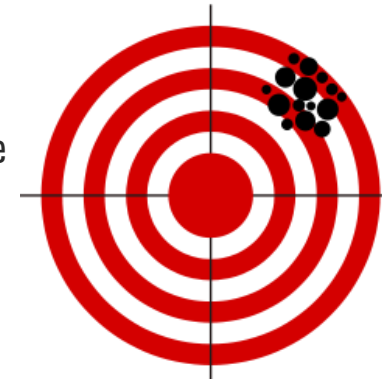
→ Internal consistency is usually expressed with Cronbach's alpha α



Unreliable & Invalid



Unreliable, But Valid



Reliable, Not Valid



Both Reliable & Valid

Validity



Face Validity
Expert judgement

Does it make sense at first sight, also to participants?



Content Validity
Completeness

Does the test cover everything it should?



Criterion Validity
Does one measurement correlate with another?

Does a test accurately predict or correlate with the criterion outcome?



Construct Validity
Am I measuring what I want to measure?

Does a set of indicators represent a concept that is not directly measurable?



Internal Validity
Causality $X \rightarrow Y$ without Z influencing the relation

Does the study design, conduct, and analysis answer the research question without bias?



External validity
Can you generalise your results?

Can the study findings can be generalized to other contexts?

Reliability

- **Sample Size (N)**
- **Test-retest**
- **Standardization**
- **Pilots**
- **Peer Feedback**
- **Reporting and justification**
- **Intersubjectivity**
- **Triangulation**
- **Iteration**

Quantitative

Qualitative

Sampling

- Set criteria for your target population, e.g. age limits or country
- Get a sample of subjects* that is as random and representative as possible.

Random: the word says it all. Don't cherry-pick or go around asking only friends and family.

Representative: The sample should contain the best mix of characteristics *within your target population*.

PROBABILITY SAMPLING:

based on the principle of randomization: random selection or chance within population or subpopulation

NON-PROBABILITY SAMPLING:

Selection is influenced by subjective boundaries and/or convenient picking from population or subpopulation

* Research units are often people, but they can also be animals or objects, for example.

Sampling: options

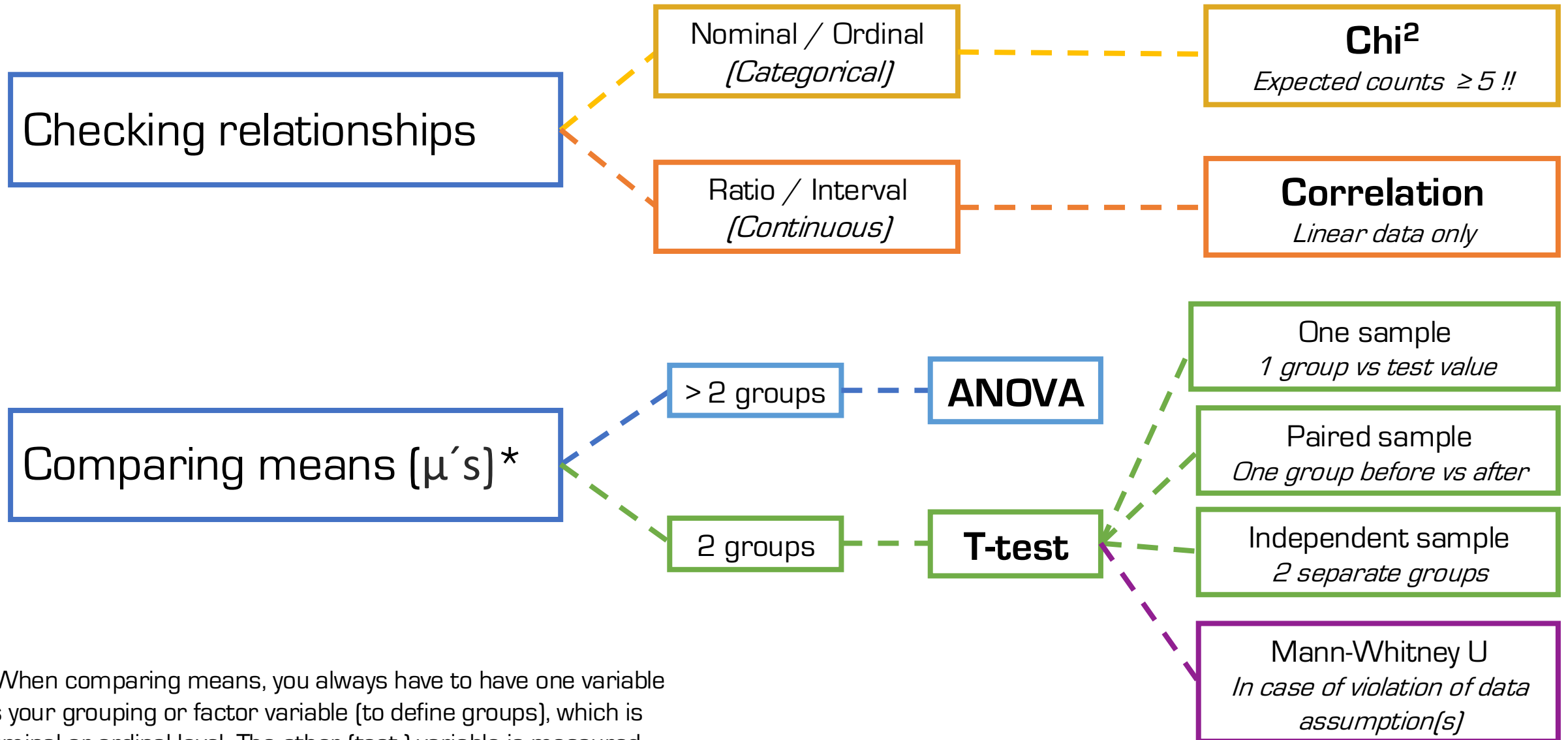
PROBABILITY SAMPLING OPTIONS

- (SIMPLE) RANDOM Any subject within the target population (random) from database/ list
- STRATIFIED Divide the population into subgroups (strata) based on a relevant characteristic, then randomly sample people from every subgroup, normally keeping the same proportions as the population.
e.g. A university has 50% Dutch, 20% German, 20% Belgian, and 10% French students. For a sample of 1,000 students, you randomly select 500 Dutch, 200 German, 200 Belgian, and 100 French students.
- CLUSTERED Divide the population into natural groups (clusters), randomly select some of those groups, and then survey everyone or a random sample of people within the selected clusters.
e.g. You want to study language students across the Netherlands, but visiting every university and HBO is impractical. You treat individual language departments or schools as clusters, randomly choose several of them, and survey students within only those selected departments.
- SYSTEMATIC Using some order or pattern to select, such as every 10th guest

NON-PROBABILITY SAMPLING OPTIONS

- SNOWBALL Any subject can select a next subject
- QUOTA Divide the population into set subgroups and select a certain number of people from each subgroup, without random selection. You continue sampling until the required quota for each subgroup is reached.
e.g. If a hotel has 80% guests staying in regular rooms and 20% staying in suites, and you want a sample of 50 guests, you select 40 guests from regular rooms and 10 guests from suites. You stop once those quotas have been reached.
- SELF-SELECTION People put themselves forward for participation
- CONVENIENCE Quick and convenient: any subject that you can find within a certain period or area. Very ´not random´.

What test to use?



*When comparing means, you always have to have one variable as your grouping or factor variable (to define groups), which is nominal or ordinal level. The other (test-) variable is measured at either interval or ratio level.

	Test	Data assumptions	Results
Checking Relationships	Chi² 2 categorical variables	All expected counts ≥ 5 Independent measures	p for significance Cramer's V for strength (0 to 1)
	Correlation 2 continuous variables	Linear data (scatterplot) No crazy outliers	p for significance Pearsons' r for strength (-1 to 1)
Comparing Means *	T-test 1 continuous & 1 categorical variable	Normally distributed data Equal variances (homogeneity)	p for significance Effect size: Cohen's d (0 to 1) or Rank biserial correlation (-1 to 1)
	ANOVA 1 continuous & 1 categorical variable Multiple groups	Equal variances (homogeneity)	p for significance Post-hoc for specific groups Groups means for specifications

* When comparing means, you always have to have one variable as your grouping or factor variable (to define groups), which is nominal or ordinal level (e.g. gender or age group). The other (test-) variable(s) is/are measured at continuous level.

CHI²

- The Chi² test, or χ^2 test, is used to see if there is a relationship between two categorical variables.
- Because categorical variables don't have numerical measures and therefore cannot be analysed using means, Chi² works with frequencies to see if there are differences between observed outcomes (your measured counts) and expected counts.
- The expected outcomes for all cells should be at least 5, and are calculated using the formula $(\text{rowtotal} \times \text{columntotal}) / N$, for example $(28 \times 32) / 106$ for cell **1-NO** in the table below
- You find the Chi² test in Jamovi under Analyses > Frequencies > Independent Samples χ^2 of association
- Jamovi provides a contingency table, the χ^2 test outcomes, and Cramer's V (if selected under *Statistics*)

Contingency Tables

		healthplan		Total
		No	Yes	
1	Observed	12	16	28
	Expected	8.45	19.55	28.00
2	Observed	18	27	45
	Expected	13.58	31.42	45.00
3	Observed	0	8	8
	Expected	2.42	5.58	8.00
4	Observed	2	18	20
	Expected	6.04	13.96	20.00
5	Observed	0	5	5
	Expected	1.51	3.49	5.00
Total	Observed	32	74	106
	Expected	32	74	106

χ^2 Tests

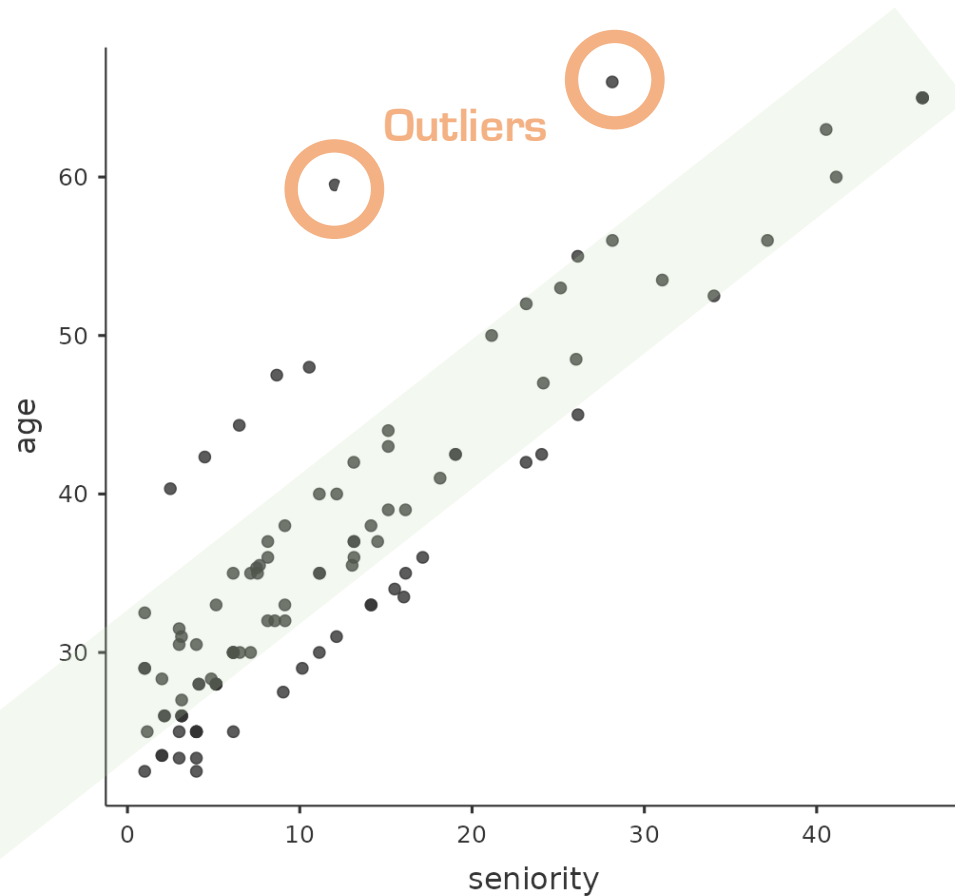
	Value	df	p
χ^2	13.7	4	0.008
N	106		

Nominal

	Value
Phi-coefficient	NaN
Cramer's V	0.359

CORRELATION

- The correlation test is used to see if there is a relationship between two continuous variables
- To check data assumptions, in Jamovi use Exploration > Scatterplot to see if data are reasonably linear or not
- You find the correlation test in Jamovi under Analyses > Regression > Correlation Matrix
- Jamovi provides a Correlation Matrix with the outcomes, among which Pearson's r



Correlation Matrix

		age	seniority
age	Pearson's r	—	
	df	—	
	p-value	—	
seniority	Pearson's r	0.882	—
	df	104	—
	p-value	<.001	—

T-TEST

- The T-test is used to compare the means (μ 's) of **two groups** for a continuous dependent variable, to see if there is a significant difference between the groups. There are 3 types of T-test.
 - One sample t-test.** Used to compare the μ of data you gathered to an already existing μ (e.g. from literature)
 - Independent t-test.** Used to compare the μ 's of two groups you observed
 - Paired samples t-test.** Used to compare the μ 's of data you gathered within one group, but at two different moments (e.g. μ heart rate before and μ after drinking coffee). This requires the same people in both groups!
- Here, you have to set clear one-sided or two-sided hypotheses to choose the right settings and interpret results correctly. *In case of one-sided testing, only half of the chosen p-value is used.* Jamovi automatically changes the p when you tick one-sided; in SPSS you would have to read to column 'one-sided'.
- You find T-tests in Jamovi under Analyses > T-tests.
- To check data assumptions, in Jamovi tick *Homogeneity test* (Levene's) and *Normality test* (Shapiro-Wilk).
 - If both p-values are **higher** than 0.05 you can move forward with a normal T-test.
 - If either one of them is violated or both are, you have to tick the *Mann-Whitney U* option and then continue. (The *Mann-Whitney U* uses medians instead of means)
- For effect size, tick *Effect Size* under *Additional Statistics*. This will add Cohen's d (applies when doing a normal t-test) and Rank biserial correlation (applies when doing the Mann-Whitney U).

Normality Test (Shapiro-Wilk)		
	W	p
perf_quantity	0.979	0.094

Note. A low p-value suggests a violation of the assumption of normality

Homogeneity of Variances Test (Levene's)				
	F	df	df2	p
perf_quantity	0.256	1	104	0.614

Note. A low p-value suggests a violation of the assumption of equal variances

Independent Samples T-Test				
		Statistic	df	p
perf_quantity	Student's t	1.43	104	0.157

Note. $H_a: \mu_2 \neq \mu_1$

Effect Size	
Cohen's d	0.383
Rank biserial correlation	-0.206

ANOVA

- ANOVA is used to compare means (μ 's) of **three or more groups** for a continuous dependent variable, to see if there is a significant difference between those groups. You have to know 2 options for ANOVA, for which the choice is based on Levene's test of homogeneity [as a data assumption].
 - ANOVA Fisher's test.** Used if homogeneity is met (so: Levene's $p > 0.05$)
 - ANOVA Welch test.** Used if homogeneity is **not** met (so: Levene's $p < 0.05$)
- You find ANOVA in Jamovi under Analyses > ANOVA > One-way ANOVA.
- To check homogeneity data assumption, in Jamovi tick *Homogeneity test* (Levene's) within the ANOVA test

However.... if a significant difference is found, we still have to see **between which groups**, for which we use post-hoc tests. These post-hoc tests show p-values for specific pairs of groups so you can report outcomes more precisely. To also report which groups scores higher than another, use descriptives to see groups' means. Post-hoc options are:

- For an ANOVA Welch test we use the Games-Howell
- For an ANOVA Fisher's test we use the Bonferroni or Tukey, for which the choice depends on acceptable risks:
 - Bonferroni is quite strict, which means a lower chance of a type I error, yet a bigger chance of a type II error
 - Tukey is less strict, which means a higher chance of a type I error, yet a smaller chance of a type II error. Jamovi only has Tukey.

Tukey Post-Hoc Test – perf_quantity

		1	2	3	4	5
1	Mean difference	—	0.365	1.132	−0.439	−1.136
	p-value	—	0.734	0.156	0.742	0.324
2	Mean difference		—	0.767	−0.804	−1.501
	p-value		—	0.486	0.117	0.081
3	Mean difference			—	−1.571	−2.268
	p-value			—	0.024	0.014
4	Mean difference				—	−0.697
	p-value				—	0.789
5	Mean difference					—
	p-value					—

Assumption Checks

Homogeneity of Variances Test (Levene's)					One-Way ANOVA					
	F	df1	df2	p		F	df1	df2	p	
perf_quantity	1.68	4	101	0.160	perf_quantity	Welch's	8.00	4	20.0	<.001
						Fisher's	4.18	4	101	0.004

NOTES

